

THE GENE SCENE

Raipur-born molecular biologist Hargobind Khurana (right) became the third Indian to win the Nobel Prize.

Awarded for his work on the interpretation of the genetic code, he hoped his work would "serve as a basis for further work in molecular and developmental biology".



AP PHOTO

- Mauritius attained independence from Britain.
- American civil rights leader Martin Luther King was assassinated by James Earl Ray in Memphis, Tennessee. His death—caused a bullet wound in the neck—gave rise to riots.
- Robert F. Kennedy died a day after he was shot by Sirhan Bishara Sirhan at the Ambassador Hotel in Los Angeles.
- France (below) became the world's fifth thermo-nuclear power as it tested the H-bomb.



AFP



"BHOLA, NEECHE SE"

Says Kishore Kumar, playing music guru to tone-deaf Bhola, played by the inimitable Sunil Dutt, asking him to sing on a lower scale. Bhola, true to his name, takes it quite literally, and slips down to the floor. Slapstick comedy met R.D. Burman's musical genius in *Padosan*, a story of a simpleton who wanted to woo his musically-inclined neighbour (Saira Banu). Mehmood's politically incorrect comedy, complete with the southern *dhoti* and accent, won him many fans.



"WE GAVE YOU EVERYTHING WE OWNED JUST TO SIT AT YOUR TABLE."

The Beatles travelled to India in February 1968 for 'transcendental meditation studies' at Maharishi Mahesh Yogi's ashram in Rishikesh. "We gave you everything we owned just to sit at your table/ Just a smile would lighten everything," they wrote later. Many of the Liverpool band's songs and albums, including *White Album*, *Abbey Road*, *Dear Prudence* and *Sexy Sadie* were inspired by their stay here.